AfDB – DI4A

SET-UP · 5 MINUTES

Two free API keys: Groq and Gemini

How to create a **Groq** key and a **Gemini** key, step by step, free and without a credit card.

`gsk_…` `AIza…`

WHY A KEY

Two free keys, one backup

RECOMMENDED

Groq

`gsk_…`

Free, no credit card, very fast answers. Sign in with Google, GitHub or email.

BACKUP

Gemini

`AIza…`

Google’s free tier in AI Studio, with your Google account.

BOTH

Free

`€0`

Neither service asks for a credit card on its free tier. One key is enough; two is safer.

BEFORE YOU START

Five minutes, no credit card

A Google account for Gemini. Groq also accepts GitHub or an email address.

A web browser: Chrome, Edge or Firefox, with pop-ups allowed for sign-in.

A safe place for the key: a password manager or a private note. Never a chat or a shared document.

Five minutes. Neither service asks for a card on its free tier.

Treat a key like a password: whoever holds it uses your quota.

PART 1

Groq

The fastest free option. Three steps, about two minutes.

1 · Sign in

2 · Create a key

3 · Copy it once

`console.groq.com/keys`

Open the console and sign in

1. Go to **console.groq.com/keys**

2. Sign in with **Google**, **GitHub** or your **email** (a one-time link is sent)

3. First visit: accept the terms. You land in the GroqCloud console.

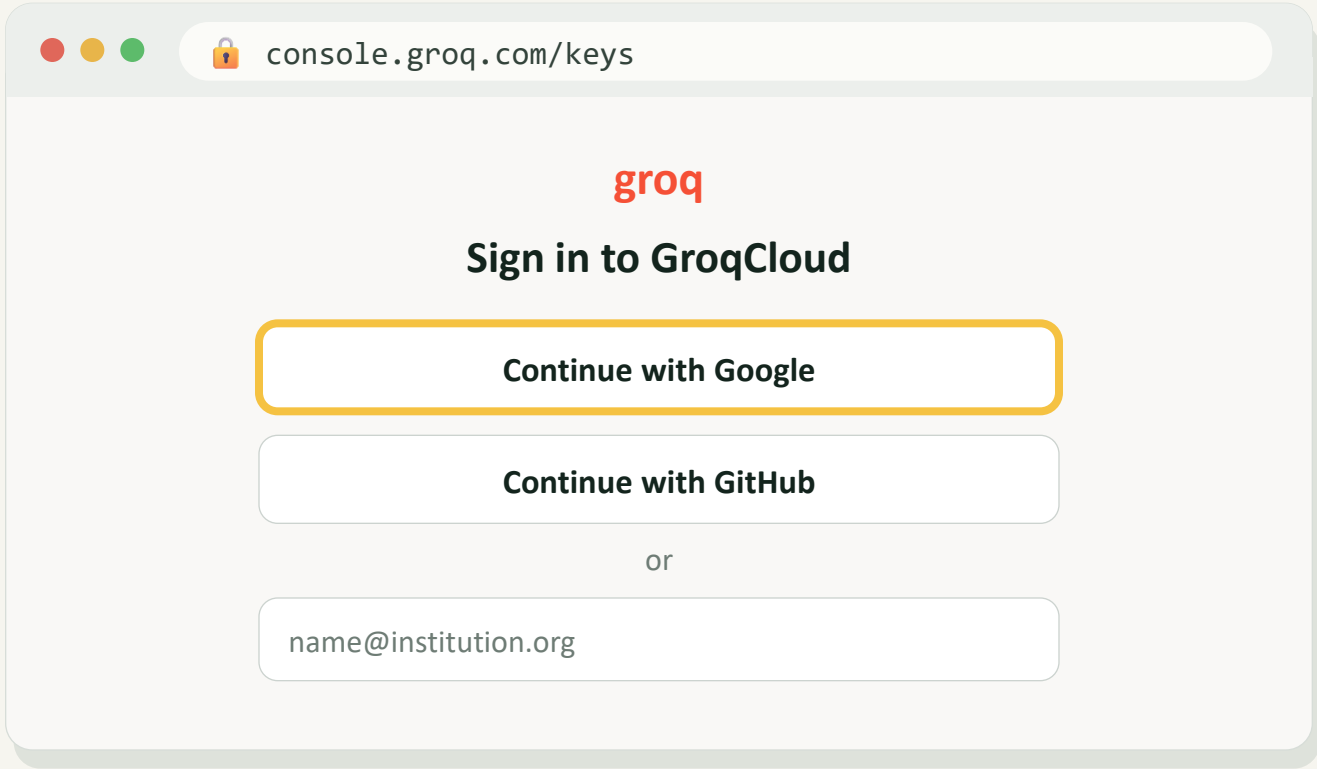


Illustration of the sign-in page; the live page may look slightly different.

Create an API key

1. Open **API Keys** in the left menu
2. Click **Create API Key**
3. Give it a name you will recognise, such as `di4a-rag`, then **Submit**

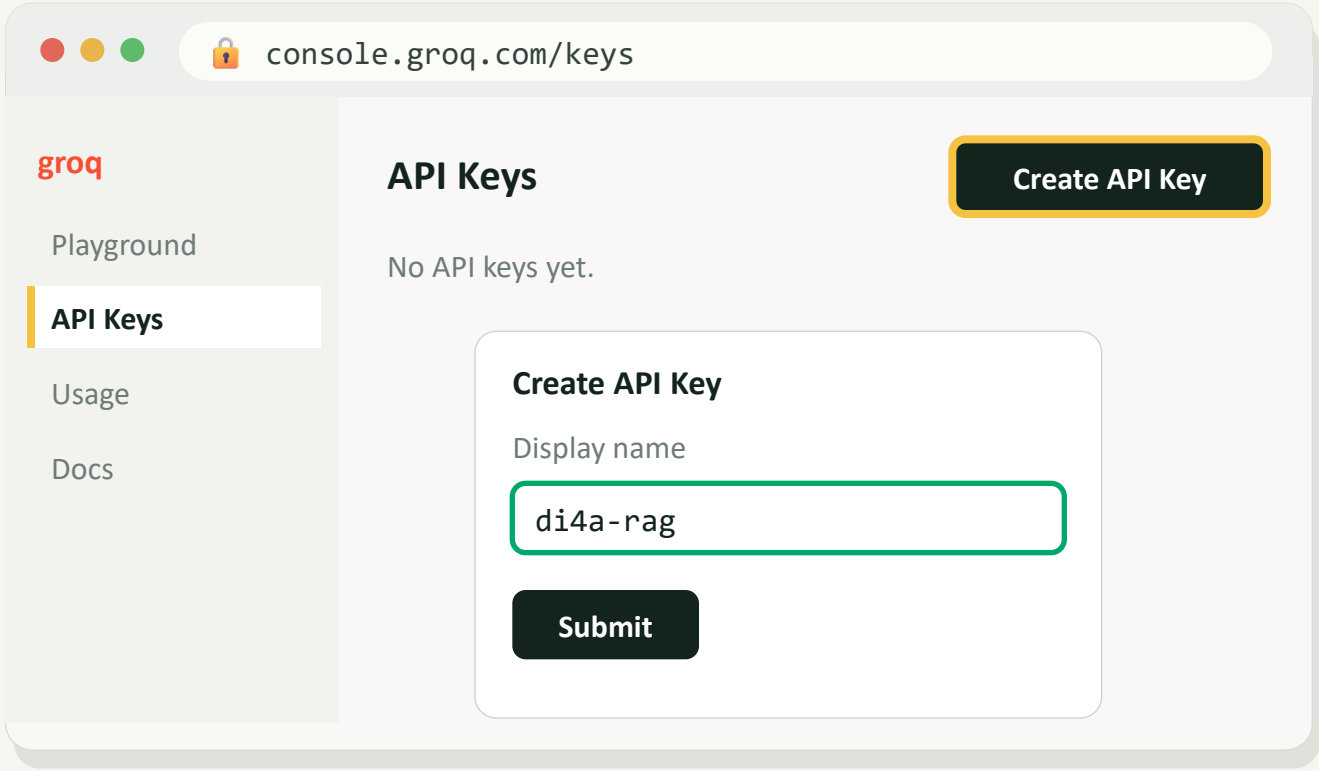
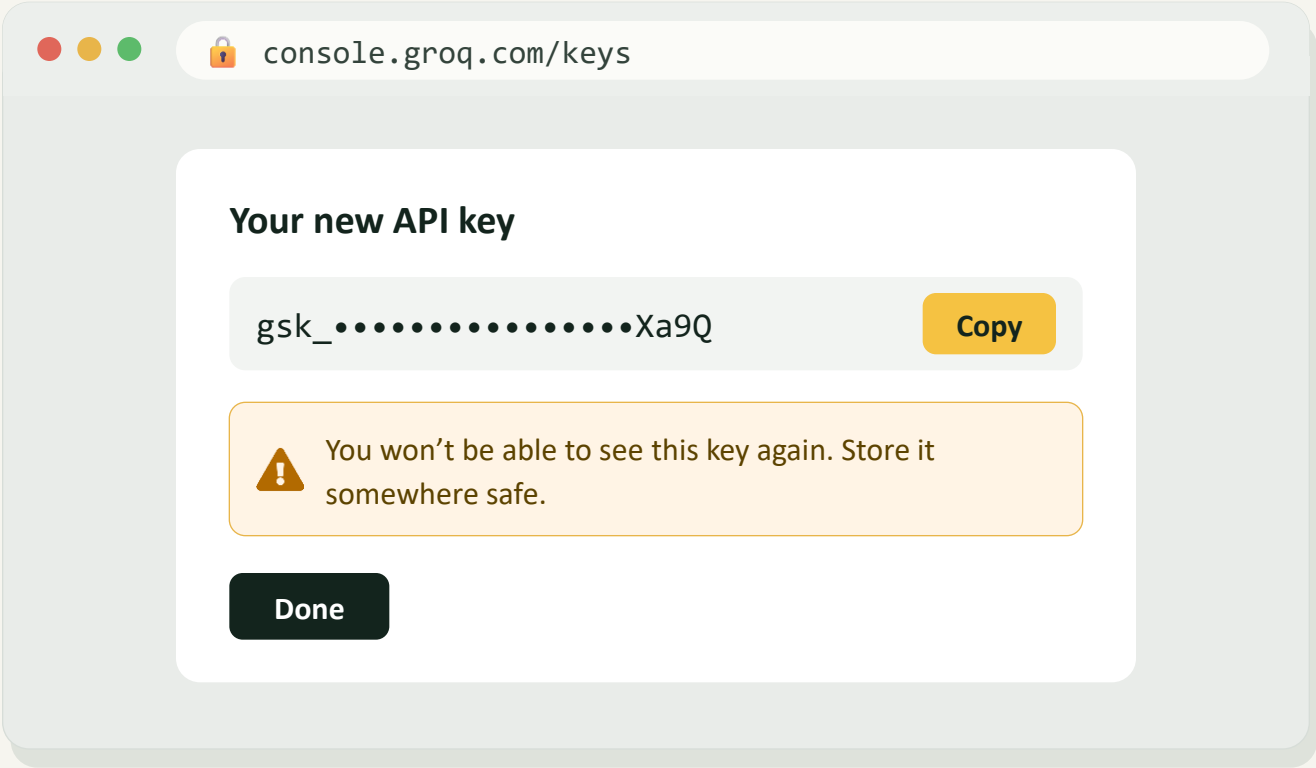


Illustration of the API Keys page; labels from the console, layout simplified.

GROQ · STEP 3 OF 3

Copy the key now: it is shown only once

1. Click the **copy** icon. The key starts with `gsk_`
2. Keep it somewhere safe: a **password manager** or a private note
3. Lost it? Delete the key and create a new one: it takes ten seconds.



Illustration; key masked. The live dialog may word the warning differently.

PART 2

Gemini

Google’s free tier, with your Google account. Two steps.

1 · Open AI Studio

2 · Create and copy the key

aistudio.google.com/apikey

GEMINI · STEP 1 OF 2

Open Google AI Studio and sign in

1. Go to **aistudio.google.com/apikey**
2. Sign in with your **Google account**
3. First visit: tick the **terms of service** box (the e-mail box is optional), then **Continue**

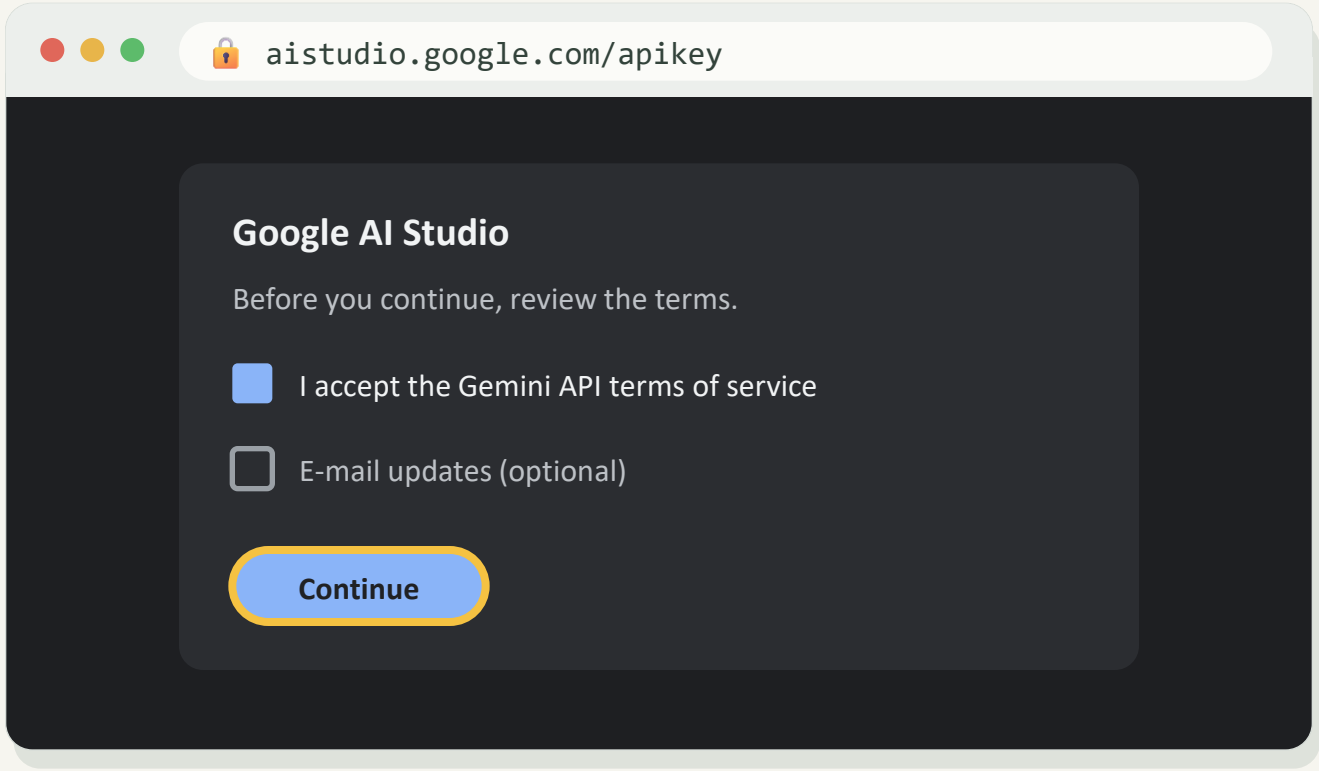


Illustration of the first-visit terms dialog; wording on the live page may differ.

GEMINI · STEP 2 OF 2

Create the key and copy it

1. Click **Create API key**, top right
2. Name it, choose a project or **create a new one**, then **Create key**
3. Click the **copy** icon. The key starts with `AIza` and stays visible in the list

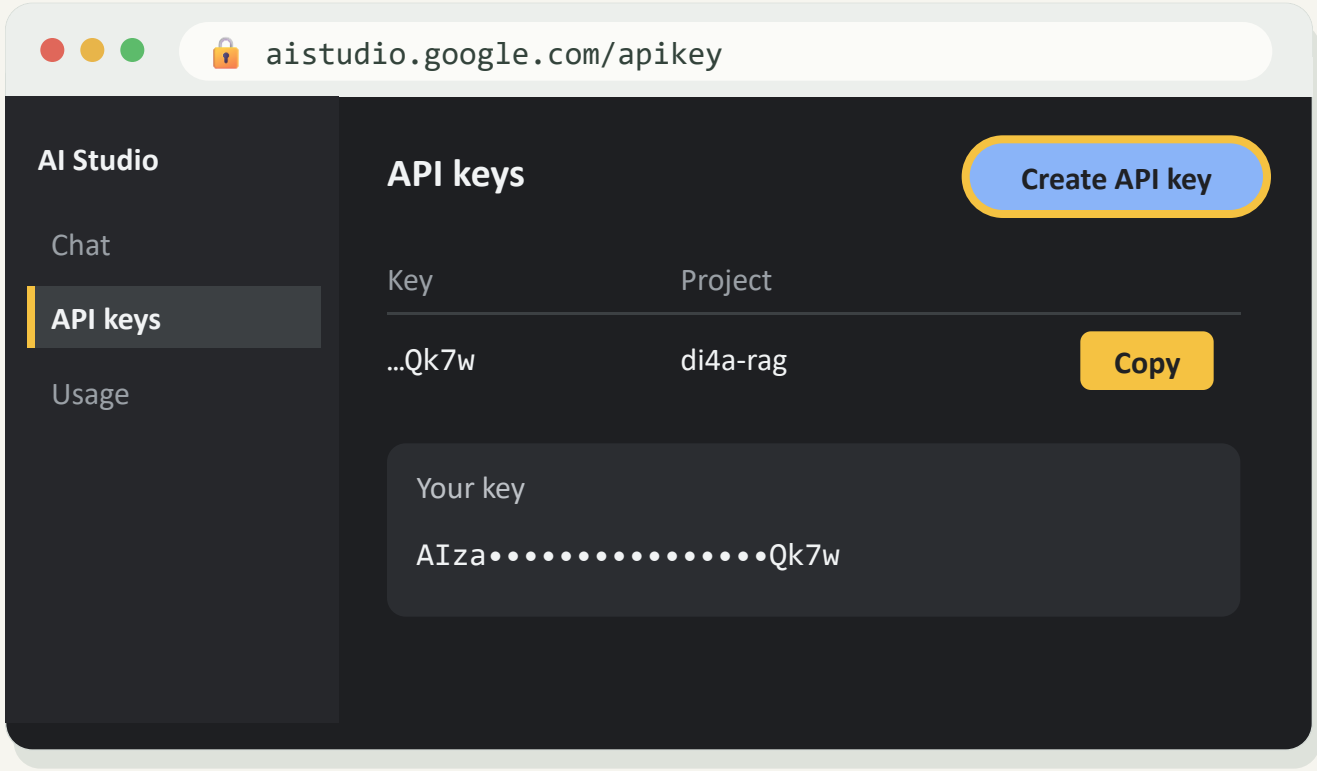


Illustration of the API keys page; key masked, layout simplified.

WHICH ONE?

Groq first, Gemini as the backup

	Groq	Gemini
Sign in with	Google, GitHub or email	Google account
Key starts with	gsk_ (shown once)	AIza (stays in the list)
Free tier	About 1,000 requests a day per model (Sept 2026)	Per-minute and daily limits by model
Speed	Very fast	Fast
What to send	Published documents only	Published documents only; free-tier prompts may be used by Google to improve its products

Limits change: check each console on the day.

STAYING SAFE

Four rules for a key

Never in a chat, an e-mail or a shared doc

Anyone who sees the key can use it, on your quota.

Published documents only

What you send through the key goes to the provider. Keep confidential material away from online models.

Leaked? Delete it now

Delete the key in the console and create a new one. The old key stops working at once.

Clean up when you are done

Delete the keys you no longer need, in Groq’s API Keys page and in AI Studio.

TROUBLESHOOTING

If something goes wrong

What you see	Likely cause	Fix
No sign-in e-mail from Groq	Spam filter or slow mail server	Check spam, or sign in with Google or GitHub
Groq dialog closed before copying	The key is shown only once	Delete that key and create a new one
AI Studio not available	Account or administrator setting	Use a personal Google account, or Groq
Asked to choose a project	No Google Cloud project yet	Choose “Create project” in the same dialog
Key shared by mistake	Anyone can now use it	Delete it in the console, create a new one

READY?

Your keys are ready

Keep your keys at hand for the RAG notebooks.